

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
RUMOMASI**

TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: SEVEN

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Comprehension & Summary (Exam Workshop)

Introduction

- In the WAEC/NECO paper, comprehension and summary carry substantial marks. This workshop consolidates the techniques: reading for the gist, answering in one's own words, and compressing points accurately under a word limit.

Comprehension technique

- Read the passage twice (gist first, then details); study the questions before the second reading; answer in full sentences; give the number of points the marks require; quote only when asked; and identify the writer's: purpose, tone, attitude, and the devices (rhetorical questions, irony, contrast) used.

Summary technique

- Underline the key points in order; write each as one short clause in your own words; keep the sequence; obey the number of points and the word limit; count the words; and write the count at the end.

Common errors and how to avoid them

- Copying from the passage (write with the passage closed); exceeding the limit (re-read and cut); giving fewer points than required (list the points before writing); pegging irrelevancies (answer only what is asked); and grammatical lapses (check tenses and agreement).

CLASS EVALUATION

1. State the steps of an examination comprehension.
2. Why must summary answers be in your own words?
3. What is the penalty for exceeding the word limit?
4. Give the two things you must count before submitting a summary.

NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
RUMOMASI

TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: EIGHT

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Oral English Revision (Vowels & Consonants)

Introduction

- Oral English tests pronunciation — the sounds of English, word stress and intonation. The paper has three sections: vowels (pure and gliding), consonants, and stress/rhythm.

Vowels

- Pure vowels (12): /i/ (see), /ɪ/ (sit), /e/ (bed), /æ/ (cat), /ɑ/ (car), /ɒ/ (hot), /ɔ/ (saw), /ʊ/ (put), /u/ (food), /ʌ/ (cup), /ɜ/ (bird), /ə/ (the schwa — the commonest sound in English). Gliding vowels (diphthongs, 8): /eɪ/ (day), /aɪ/ (my), /ɔɪ/ (boy), /ɔʊ/ (go), /aʊ/ (now), /ɪə/ (ear), /eə/ (air), /ʊə/ (tour).

Consonants

- 24 consonant sounds: the stops (/p, b, t, d, k, g/), fricatives (/f, v, θ, ð, s, z, ʃ, ʒ, h/), affricates (/tʃ, dʒ/), nasals (/m, n, ŋ/), laterals (/l/) and approximants (/r, w, j/). The trouble pairs: /θ/ think vs /s/ sink; /ð/ this vs /d/ the; /v/ vest vs /w/ west; /ʃ/ sheep vs /tʃ/ chip.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Write the symbols for: see, cat, bird, go.
2. How many pure vowels are in English?
3. Distinguish /θ/ from /s/ with examples.
4. Which two consonants are called affricates?

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: NINE

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Oral English: Stress & Intonation

Introduction

- Word stress is the syllable said with more force; sentence stress places force on the content words; intonation is the rise and fall of the voice. Both carry meaning.

Word stress

- English words of two syllables usually stress the first (REcord as a noun; reCORD as a verb; COMfort; HOtel — but hoTEL is common in Nigeria, though the standard is HOtel). Suffixes shift stress: photoGRAPH → phoTOgraphy; TELEphone → teLEphony. Compound nouns stress the first element (BLACKboard, POSTman); compound adjectives the second (well-KNOWN).

Sentence stress and rhythm

- Content words (nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs) are stressed; function words (articles, prepositions, pronouns) are weak — pronounced /ə/ or reduced: 'I'm going to the market' → /aɪm ˈgəʊɪŋ tə ðə ˈmɑːkɪt/. Rhythm comes from the regular pattern of stressed syllables.

Intonation

- Falling ■ for statements, commands and wh-questions ('Where are you going? ■'); rising ■ for yes/no questions ('Are you coming? ■'), lists (except the last item) and surprise; the fall-rise for reservations or 'not yet' attitudes.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Place the stress on: record (verb), hotel, photograph, understand.
2. Give one example of a content word and a function word.
3. Draw the intonation for a yes/no question.
4. Why is the schwa so frequent in English speech?

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: TEN

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Letter Writing Revision

Introduction

- Letter writing remains a full question in the exam: formal, semi-formal and informal letters, with the format and tone tested. This week revises both formats with current, full-length examples.

Format recap

- Formal: address + date (top right), recipient's address (left), salutation, capitalised subject (in some), body, subscription (Yours faithfully for 'Dear Sir/Madam'), signature + full name. Informal: address + date, friendly salutation, opening enquiries, body of news, closing with good wishes, signature.

Exam prompts

- Application letters, letters of complaint, to the editor on social issues, invitations, congratulatory and letters of sympathy, letters on moral or civic topics. The examiner rewards: a clear purpose, the correct format, four or five paragraphs, the right tone, specific details, and no contractions in formal letters.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Write a letter to the chairman of your LGA complaining about bad roads (formal, with format).
2. What tone is used in a letter of congratulation?
3. Differentiate the subscriptions of formal and informal letters.
4. How many paragraphs does an exam letter need?

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: ELEVEN

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Formal Essay Revision (Expository, Argumentative & Narrative)

Introduction

- The essay question carries 50 marks in the paper (content, organisation, expression and mechanical accuracy). Candidates may be asked to write: narrative, descriptive, expository (explanatory/debate), argumentative or the letter-type essay.

Essay types and their demands

- **Narrative** — tell the story with a plot, in the past tense, with vivid details and a conclusion that rounds it off. **Descriptive** — describe a person, place, object or event with the senses, organised in space or time. **Expository** — explain a process or a topic ('How to prevent malaria') objectively. **Argumentative** — take a stand and defend it with evidence, conceding the other side.

Planning and presentation

- Plan for 5 minutes (the points in order); write an introduction that states the topic (and your stand, if argumentative); develop each point in a paragraph — 4 or 5 paragraphs for about 450 words; conclude briefly; and leave 5 minutes to check spelling and punctuation.

What the examiner marks

- Content (relevance and depth, up to 20), organisation (flow and paragraphing, 10), expression (vocabulary and sentences, 10), and mechanical accuracy (spelling, punctuation, grammar, 10). A well-planned, well-written 450-word essay scores far above a long, irrelevant one.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. State the four things the examiner awards marks for.
2. Plan a 450-word essay on 'The effects of drug abuse on Nigerian youths'.
3. Distinguish expository from argumentative essays.
4. Why is the introduction important in an argumentative essay?

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: TWELVE

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Grammar & Usage Revision (Concord, Tense & Punctuation)

Introduction

- Grammar is the engine of the essay and the objective test. The commonest exam errors are concord (subject–verb agreement), tense inconsistency and punctuation faults. This week revises all three.

Concord rules

- A singular subject takes a singular verb: 'The boy plays'; 'Each of the boys HAS a book'; 'Every day IS a gift'; 'Either of the answers IS correct'; 'Neither the teacher nor the students WERE...' — with 'neither...nor', the verb agrees with the nearer subject. 'The number of students IS...' but 'A number of students ARE...'. Expressions like 'as well as', 'together with', 'along with' do not change the number of the subject ('The man, as well as his sons, IS here'). 'None' can take singular or plural; collective nouns (committee, family) take singular when acting as one body, plural when the members act separately.

Tense and aspect

- Use the simple past for a finished action; the present perfect for a past action with a present result ('He has gone'); the past perfect for the earlier of two past actions ('He had left before I arrived'); the present tense for facts and habitual acts. Avoid shifting tenses carelessly; use 'since' with the perfect — 'He has been here since 2020' (not 'He is here since').

Punctuation and common faults

- Use the comma for lists and after introductory phrases; the semicolon to join two related sentences; the apostrophe for possession and contraction ('the boys' books; 'it's = it is'); avoid the comma splice (a comma joining two sentences — use a full stop, semicolon or a coordinator); avoid fused sentences; capitalise the first word of every sentence, proper nouns and the word 'I'.

CLASS EVALUATION

- Correct: 'Each of the boys have a book.'
- Choose: 'Neither the teacher nor the students (was/were) present.'

3. Correct: 'He is here since 2020.'
4. Why is a comma splice wrong?
5. Punctuate: 'the childrens toys are in the box'.